

Jupiter

Banded giant

Diameter 88,846 miles (142,984 km)

Mass compared to Earth 318

Average distance from Sun 484 million miles
(778.3 million km)

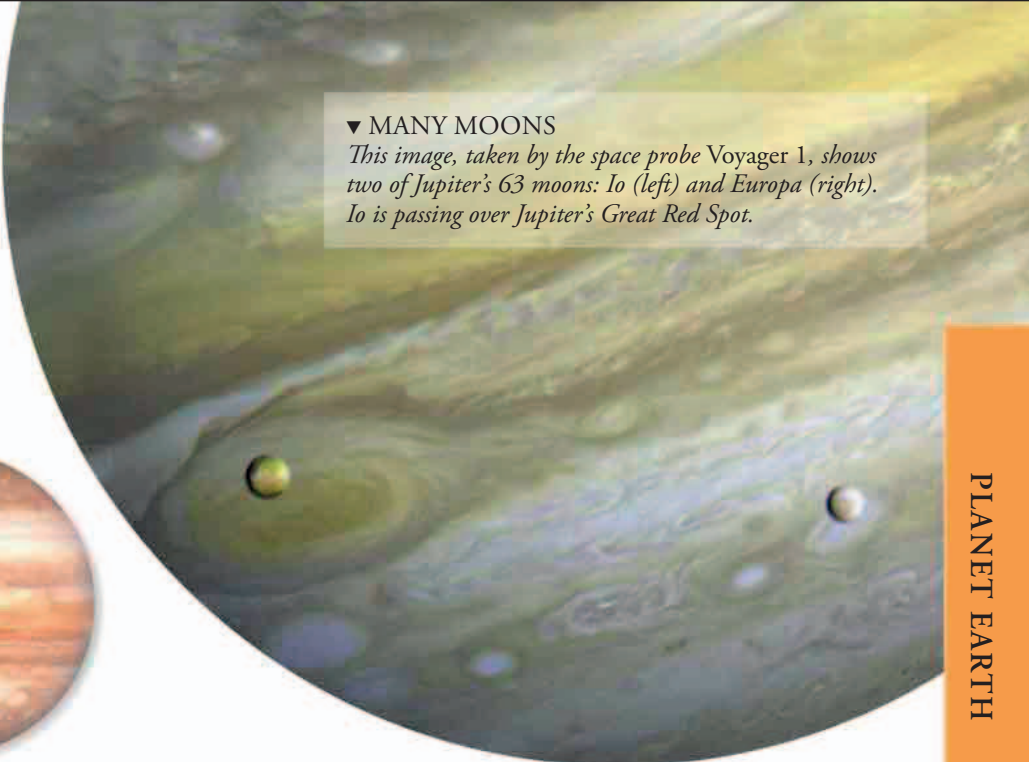
Number of moons 63

Jupiter is a colossal ball of mainly hydrogen and helium gas, with more than twice the mass of all the other planets put together. Huge storms rage across the surface, including the Great Red Spot, which is twice the size of Earth. One of Jupiter's 63 rocky moons, Europa, is covered by ice that may conceal liquid water.



▼ MANY MOONS

This image, taken by the space probe Voyager 1, shows two of Jupiter's 63 moons: Io (left) and Europa (right). Io is passing over Jupiter's Great Red Spot.



Saturn

Icy rings

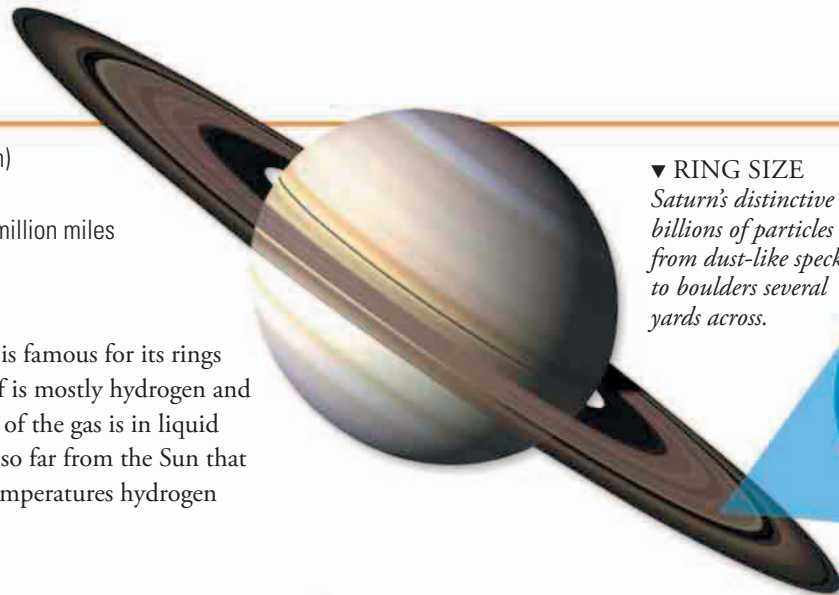
Diameter 74,914 miles (120,536 km)

Mass compared to Earth 95

Average distance from Sun 891 million miles
(1.4 billion km)

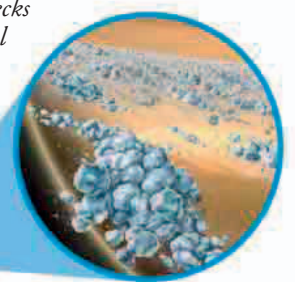
Number of moons 60

The second largest planet, Saturn, is famous for its rings of fragmented ice. The planet itself is mostly hydrogen and helium gas, like Jupiter, but much of the gas is in liquid form. This is because the planet is so far from the Sun that it's extremely cold—at such low temperatures hydrogen and other gases become liquid.



▼ RING SIZE

Saturn's distinctive rings are made up of billions of particles of ice ranging in size from dust-like specks to boulders several yards across.



Uranus

Frozen planet

Diameter 31,763 miles (51,118 km)

Mass compared to Earth 14.5

Average distance from Sun
1.8 billion miles (2.9 billion km)

Number of moons 27

Bitterly cold methane clouds cover the massive ball of gas and ice that forms Uranus. The planet is tilted sideways on its axis—probably because of a huge collision early in its history—so its north and south poles are almost aligned with the Sun. This means that its many rocky moons seem to orbit the planet from top to bottom, rather than from side to side.



Neptune

Windy world

Diameter 30,760 miles (49,532 km)

Mass compared to Earth 17.1

Average distance from Sun
2.8 billion miles (4.5 billion km)

Number of moons 13

Neptune is so far from Earth that no one knew for certain that it existed until the 19th century. Like Uranus, it is largely made of a mixture of frozen gases, including the methane that gives it its deep blue color. It has a stormy atmosphere with recorded wind speeds of up to 1,300 mph (2,100 km/h), the fastest in the Solar System.

